

I: Ok so first of all how would you like us to name your partner?

P: I don't know, is it embarrassing to give your partner's first name?

I: Not at all.

P: Is it confidential?

I: Yes.

P: Is it confidential? I don't know if you're going to transcribe his first name.

I: It depends on how you prefer. It's up to you to facilitate the exchange.

P: Ok. Well, you can say his first name is [partner].

I: [partner]?

P: Yes.

I: Ok very good. So how long have you been with [partner]?

P: [16-20] years.

I: [16-20] years okay. So I'd like you to tell me about your love story, so the relationship you currently have with [partner].

P: Currently?

I: In general, how you met.

P: Ah, it's buggy, I think.

I: You hear that? Ah it bugged me too. Ah because it's good, so you can hear?

P: I can hear you, I can't see you but I can hear you. Ah, it's bugged. That's it, I can see you. So that's it. Sorry about that.

I: Not at all.

P: So yes, you want, well what can I tell you about where we are today, is that it?

I: Well, as a whole, yes, how you met.

P: Because a lot has happened in [16-20] years.

I: Whatever.

P: Ok, well today I'm a couple, well I'm married to [partner], so we've been together for [16-20] years, we've been married for almost, well almost [1-5] years, it'll be [1-5] years this year, and we've been parents of a little girl for almost [1-5] years. Well, I'd say that our relationship has evolved, in fact, it's different now from what it was [16-20] years ago, that's for sure, but at the same time we're not the same age. Today, well, we met when we were [16-20], we got together when we were [16-20], and today we're almost [31-35]. So we're not the same people any more, and our relationship hasn't evolved at all, and there have also been factors that have meant that it's not at all the same

as it was a few years ago, particularly the child, the arrival of the child, which has reshuffled a lot of cards, and personally, and as a result in our relationship as a couple, it's clear that it's finally a passage in our, it's clearly a change in fact in our relationship, this event, it's really been a change.

I: So you say that your relationship has evolved, how would you say it has evolved, what has changed, for example?

P: Well, obviously, we'd already evolved in certain respects, since we made plans together, we got to know each other, we lived with our parents, we got an apartment, we made plans to buy a property together, we went through things that weren't very cool in that respect, precisely because we'd bought an apartment that we never got to live in, and so we went through a trial in the sense that we were in legal proceedings, we had defects on our apartment, so things that were pretty hard to live with personally and in our relationship despite everything. We were a bit, well, there were frustrations, disappointments in relation to that in particular and projects that weren't progressing, joint projects that weren't progressing, so effectively it contributed to weakening our relationship a little at one point to the point where we almost split up at one point because of that in fact and all the heaviness there was around that in the end, We weren't on the same wavelength, or at least our feelings weren't the same, and our ways of expressing our frustration or disappointment and sadness certainly weren't the same. For the moment, I'm not making any generalizations and in fact I haven't been in a relationship long enough to make any generalizations, but despite everything I still have the impression that it's societal in the sense that women and men don't communicate in the same way, but I think it's more than that, I have a partner who has difficulty communicating, it's complicated for him, whereas for me it's quite fluid and I need to express myself, He tends to keep to himself, so it's true that these are things that inevitably go wrong at some point, and there are bound to be times when things come to a head, because I need to communicate and express myself, which I'm very good at doing, So it's true that there was a period when, after all that had happened, all those tensions in our lives meant that we came to tensions in our relationship too, So it's not just that, but it's true that it was a combination of things, and then I think there are also periods in our lives and in the life of our couple that make us question ourselves personally, there are also stages, perhaps of age or professional milestones, it's really a whole, which means that at a given moment, one of us will move forward a little faster, that's how I'd like to imagine it, but move forward a little faster and then the other will lag a little behind, I have the impression, and then at a given moment it readjusts, and at some point there are bound to be small disparities, because after all, we're two individuals before we're a couple, and so yes, for us there was the ordeal of buying and all the problems that came with it, which effectively led to a quasi-tromperie, well I was going to say quasi, it depends on what you mean by deception, but for me it was a deception because already, when it's platonic, it's still, and there's really an exchange and something concrete, it's still quite far from betraying the couple. There was no physical deception, but there was psychological deception, well, I don't know how to put it, but there it is. And so yes, there was a big question mark, a big question mark about whether we should stay together or not. We stayed together and continued to make plans, and it was precisely by making other plans that we were able to set up this, this event, and then we questioned ourselves, we dared to go against what we had planned with this apartment. We let go, we decided to move to another region, to change our lives in fact, as a result of that, but the very thing that weakened our relationship was the cheating. And so, in a way, it gave us the impetus to change direction and life,

even myself. And so, for my part at least, it helped me to make sense of it, by telling myself that, in the end, even after the failure of our real estate purchase project and what followed, I made sense of it by saying to myself, maybe my life was somewhere else after all. And so we decided to move to another region, and in the end, one project followed another as we moved to another region. So there you have it, somewhere there was a new impetus. It didn't solve everything, I think there were also things that remained underlying in relation to that event, which weakened our relationship on my side. We moved on, changed regions, decided to get married, start a family and have a child. We thought a lot about it, especially the child, because we'd already been together for [11-15] years, [11-15] years, so it's a project that we really thought through, because before that we had the situation for, the financial situation, well finally there was this event with the purchase and so on. But that's not what slowed us down in our desire to have a child. Personally, I didn't want to before. So it was really a very thought-out and deliberate project. And love was really at the heart of it all anyway. Then came the arrival of our child, and yes, other things happened. But that's a bit classic. I don't think we realize, until we've had a child, just how much it's changing us. Even if we've already done some work on ourselves - well, I have, my partner hasn't really, but I expected it to come to the best of things, but I didn't expect so much. Especially as I did just before getting pregnant, there were a lot of things going on at the same time. I got married, or at least we did. I'm speaking for myself, because this is my interview, but when we got married, we actually had this plan to have a child, which was quite simultaneous with that. But at the same time, professionally speaking, things weren't going well for me. And so I was really on the verge of burnout. I got there, you know, professional exhaustion, bordering on burn-out. And in the end, I had this project for a child that was very much wanted and very... well, it was very clear to me, but at the same time there was this side of my life that wasn't very stable, in any case that wasn't going well. And so, in the end, I ended up suffering from burnout, and together I held on, held on until I had my vacations, for my wedding etc., and I held on, but I didn't really listen to myself. And in fact I reached burnout at the same time as I got pregnant. So there were a few... well, the fact that I got pregnant helped me to get through that period, to make sense of things once again and to say okay. My first thought was that it wasn't the right time, but in the end it was... yes, I think that even today, looking back, I think it was the right time for me, because otherwise I think it would have been projects that might have waited, been postponed, etc. And in fact I think I'm one of those people who would have had to wait and see if it was the right time. And in fact, I think I'm one of those people who needs a bit of that, to be pushed a little and faced with the fact, well faced with a bit of... in front of the cliff to jump. So there you have it, but it's true that it wasn't easy at the time and for the rest of the project. That thing, the fact that I was really on the edge of a precipice and had reached the end of what I could give professionally speaking. Ok, I was pregnant, it was great, a great pregnancy even if it was confinement etc. and there were things that weren't easy, but in the end I think that's what I had to live with and in fact yeah, I have very good memories of my pregnancy and the confinement etc.. However, the big slap in the face I took when my daughter arrived, just afterwards in fact, because the birth was the same, I had a very... I had a very good birth. I have good memories and I know it could have been even better, but I'm very at peace with it. It was the aftermath that really knocked me for a loop, with the burn-out coming back to haunt me. There's also a little thing I experienced when I got pregnant and when I stopped working because I couldn't go on at all, and that's that my father had a stroke. So there were really a lot of things going on at the same time, and I think that... there was the postpartum period and all that that entails, all the fragility that I had at that time with

everything that had happened before. Postpartum, I clearly had postpartum depression and in my relationship it was a crucial period, well I don't know how to put it, for today, where I am today in my relationship, this time in fact, even the immediate postpartum at the maternity hospital, there are things that have meant that today, voilà, my relationship is fragile. My relationship with my partner has been weakened by my immediate postpartum period. And I know how to verbalize it, I know at what point there were things that happened, etc. And I think that these are the things that are at stake. And I think that these are things that weren't necessarily settled, or very much calmed down by what had happened before, particularly in September, which have also come back a little. So, today I'd say that on paper I'm on a very classic family pattern, married, we've bought a house, we've got a healthy baby, that's it, but on the other hand, yes, we've recently started talking about separation. And that's that. Okay, yes, [Name].

I: [Name], compare the quality of your current relationship with the quality of your friends' relationships. What would you say?

P: Well, I have the impression that it's all the same. I was talking about a slightly societal effect earlier, but I have the impression that it's a bit like that all the same. In the end, all my friends, if I talk to them, who have children, etc., there really has been this baby clash, because that's clearly what it is. But it's even more than that, a clash for me is a clash and then it's over, there's a big clash and then it's over, it's calmed down. It's more than that, it's deeper and longer and more intense than that, for me. And I'd say, in the end, we all go through it. For me, really, I don't want to be defeatist in saying this, but I have the impression that it's really very, very common. I've got friends who split up, I've got others who stay together, but you can feel, as with us a little bit, this thing that's a bit very... that hovers a bit. It's not out of the question, separation is not out of the question and it's even a fairly regular question. I don't know how to put it, but it's a bit like that. I don't want to paint a black and white picture, but I sense that it's not all the same, that there are underlying things. And without judging anyone, I have the impression that it's a bit illusory, because we are the ideal couple, clearly, above everyone else, especially our marriage, which was really not... [Name] and [partner], they really are the ideal couple. Some people aren't as aware of what happened to us, in quotation marks, before, and I think that's something that's... I think everyone sees what they want to see in each other. I think people idealize relationships a bit too, and we're clearly idealized. We used to be a very close couple, but we're not anymore, I don't think we are. After that, I think we preserve that too, even if I don't feel like preserving it, it's a bit annoying, it wears me out a bit to play the perfect couple, I don't feel like that at all, and in fact I've changed a bit in relation to that, I think that years ago, I used to do that too, I used to play that game a bit. Today, if I'm really asked, I'm quite ready to say, afterwards, I'm not going to throw things in people's faces, well no, in fact, I don't want to throw things in people's faces either, but at the same time, I don't want to lie to people who are really interested in how things are going in your relationship, well yes, I can say it quite honestly, it's not all out there, far from it, and I can even go into a lot of detail, without any problem. But I wouldn't say the same about my partner, I think he's really preserving that image, and he doesn't want to at all, he's still very much into the image, into what he can send back, and that's something that bothers me a little today, because in fact, we're human, and in fact, we're like all couples, and we have problems as a couple, and I think that if tomorrow, we talk seriously about the separation, he understands that it's serious, that I'm serious about it, and I think that, yes, he's not ready to tell people, and I think that, yes, everyone, if

tomorrow, we say, well, really, we're doing this, we're separating, everyone's going to fall down very hard. And I think that's a bit of a shame, but in the same way that I'm in favor of free speech today, but on all subjects, in particular, I'm a feminist, that's clear and unambiguous, and in any case, I think that as soon as you're a woman, you're a feminist. It's just that we... it's not a dirty word, in fact, to be a feminist, necessarily, we preach our cause, and we're quite right to do so, and fortunately, what, in fact, and I'm for... well, the floor, yeah, for all the people, in fact, who haven't had it, and us too, you know, us women, us too. So, yeah, I'm really in favor of freedom of speech on all subjects, and the couple too, in fact, because, well, it's like a lot of subjects, it's a bit taboo, and I think that's a shame, and I think it's meant to... I think it would reassure people, and maybe help a lot of people, instead of going straight to the separation, to know that, in fact, yes, it's the same for others, just as it is for postpartum. You should know that I'm undergoing retraining, well, professional retraining, so I've changed jobs, particularly as a result of all this, all this upheaval, and my maternity, but even before that, because, well, as I told you, there was this exhausting pro, and I no longer had a sense of purpose in my job, anyway, but where I had a revelation was the fact of being a mother and having gone through what I went through postpartum, and, in fact, I am, today, I'm a [occupation], in fact. So, really, I find that the taboos of postpartum, and even pregnancy, and all that it can, in fact, induce, I think it's really important to say. And it helped me a lot, even if it doesn't take away everything you go through on a daily basis, and the suffering you can feel, and the pain, in fact, because that's really what it is, and what's more, it's a depression that's smiling, like many depressions, it's not the only one, but... And so, I find that the couple is also important, and that's part of my job, I want to help mothers, but couples too, in the end, and that's it, and the couple, and all the phases we can go through, it's important to say it, it's important to say that, in fact, it's not all rosy, what. And then, maybe we'll talk about it, but today's social networks, which embellish all that, whether it's, as with all subjects, clearly, whether it's to make life perfect, the postpartum perfect, the couple perfect, well, there you go, it's... And then, voilà, it's not... Getting out of this binary system a little bit too, it's not... It's the system itself. There are lots of other things too. There are lots of other moments, and that's what couples are all about, but like life in the end. It's the best thing, it's... Well, that's that. Yeah, so yes, you'll say that you find yourself, so, ultimately, in other couples, in the end. Yeah, totally. After that, we all have our stories. We all have our stories, and all... Well, we don't all have the same love story, we don't all have the same relationship with... To our spouses, to our partners, well, we all have a different story, so we can't say, yes, it's the same for everyone. But there's a bit of it, of them, it's the same. I mean, there are lots of things that can be echoed, in fact, in each story, in the end. But don't get everything mixed up, because we don't all have the same stories, and even... After that, I don't want to put degrees, in fact, to... How shall I put it? To suffering, to violence, etc., because me, for example, I'm in a very healthy couple, after all. I have a partner who has always respected me, I've never been abused, and so on. On the other hand, there are certain... On many points, I don't feel respected, in fact, and I don't feel considered. So, yeah, I'd say that, well, even if we don't all have the same stories, and there are indeed stories where there are things that aren't healthy, well, compared to couples who are rather healthy, love stories that are rather healthy, in the sense that there's no violence, either physical or verbal, or... It doesn't go very far, and there aren't any really perverse mechanisms, in fact, in the couple. Well, even in healthy couples, where we respect each other, well, in the couple, well yes, there's still... Excuse me, my head's a bit creaky. There are misunderstandings, problems, issues, situations where we don't feel listened to, respected, loved,

in fact, at our true value, and even loved at all, that's all. And then, well, there's also the fact that I think everyone has to work on themselves too. I think a couple is two people, but that's it. So, that's my vision, and without any judgement, but for me, a healthy couple is actually people who are already well in tune with themselves, in fact, and then, well, they make two. Or more, afterwards, with the child, etc., or even, voilà, afterwards, polyamory, etc. It doesn't concern me, but why not, I totally respect that, that's all.

I: Ok, yes. And then, I don't know if it's possible, because you told me you met young people very early in your life, but I was going to say, if you can compare it to previous relationships, maybe?

P: Well, yes, well, I've had some very short relationships, well, I had a relationship, well, at [16-20], I had a relationship of almost [1-5] year with a young man, then. I'd say that, for the time being, I'm quite, well, I'm fine with that, because it was really my first, him, it was really my first love story. I'd had a boyfriend before. Well, let's just say that I've had [1-5] boyfriends where I didn't feel respected, so I'll tell you about that, but on the other hand, this one, which was my first love affair, and the first person, in fact, with whom I had a sexual relationship, I was very much respected. And I think that played a big part in my relationship with [partner]. After that, I still consider myself very lucky, in the end, to have also had, it's the first story that was, in the end, a beautiful story, I had some heartache at the end, it's not my fault if we split up, but as a result, yeah, I was respected and I was, well, it was a very simple relationship, so that's great and I'm happy to have had that relationship and ditto with [partner] afterwards. After that, the very first boyfriend I had was when I was very young, and I didn't have a sexual relationship with him. So, in the end, it's not that it was unhealthy because this person didn't, wasn't disrespectful, but on the other hand, when I look at myself in hindsight, I say to myself that I'm pleased with myself, in fact, for having been able to say no to him, that it wasn't what I wanted and that it was too quick for me, etc. And for having been able to say no to him, that it wasn't what I wanted and that it was too quick for me. And I'm glad I respected myself and listened to what he had to say. So there you go, but he didn't disrespect me because, there you go, he understood that and there you go, but it's true that it was my first bit... it brought me face to face with, ok, the reality of male-female relationships, in the end. Well, the reality that isn't necessarily a reality, because I was very respected afterwards. When I had my first sexual relationship, for example, I was really... well, I wasn't forced at all, it was really consensual and wanted by both of us, and so on. So there you go. And even with [partner], it was really, really... yeah, I was really respected. So I'm very grateful for that, but at the same time, I'm also grateful to myself, because I listened to myself too. I'm not saying that I was lucky to have come across such respectful men, but yes, I'm glad I did. And then, on the other hand, before [partner] too, I had a flirt somewhere. For me, he was a boyfriend. Afterwards, I think he enjoyed it more, sexually speaking. And I didn't feel respected twice about that. In fact, I understood that this person just wanted that, in the end. And that was that. Afterwards, I didn't... well, I have the impression that I quickly put an end to... well, yeah, it was twice, and yeah, actually, it pissed me off. So that was it. But it's okay, I'm kind of over it. I don't feel complete, I mean, I don't feel dirty, I don't feel... I don't feel dirty, I don't feel... So it's fine. And then, if there's one experience that was... well, where it was a relationship... well, it's not a relationship, in fact, at all. I think I came very close, in fact, to being raped at a party. And that, yeah, it was complicated to live with, but particularly because I had friends at that party who didn't... well, fortunately, there was a friend who came, and I remember that, I was drunk, so I could, in fact, have ended up being raped because I wasn't really aware of

what was happening to me. And then, a friend came to get me, and I think that, without that friend, it would probably have happened... well, there would have been sexual intercourse, in particular, and I wasn't in the right frame of mind for it. I remember having a sort of flashback to myself at that moment, when that friend came looking for me. But then, it wasn't at all a long-term relationship, it was a [Event] party where I was very drunk, and then, well, there was that thing where, in fact, someone could have taken advantage of me. But otherwise, my relationship with men is very healthy. I mean, pretty healthy. After that, I've had the experience of certain people who could have really... well, I'm not naive, I think, about the reality of certain relationships that can be unhealthy, and some... I wouldn't say some men are unhealthy, because, well, it's, once again, it's societal, and even if I think they could do more than their share on a lot of things, and precisely, well, on the fact of being real men, but as we women understand it, and not real macho men, disrespectful, etc.. But, no, I've had... I've had very healthy relationships with men, and even, I'd like to say, I've got a daughter today, and I hope for her sake that she'll have this experience, in fact, finally, an experience, well, there you go, neither traumatic nor unhealthy, and that she'll know how to listen to herself, and that she'll be respected, what, that she'll be respected, as I said in the end. I think I was really respected, well there you go, there were those two things, in particular this young man in the evening, but likewise, I don't even necessarily blame him, because likewise, he was very drunk, and in fact, I have the impression that he too was a little manipulated, but well, there you go, I wouldn't know any more about that story. So, even though the context could have traumatized me, and that's something that's stayed with me, I don't necessarily blame the man. And on the other hand, yes, the other person, a bit more, because I knew he was very aware of what he was doing, but for all that, I don't really care, because I wasn't in love with that person, and that's it. So no, I'm quite at peace. No, that's good.

I: Now, I'd like you to tell me what a high-quality relationship means to you.

P: Well, I'd say that a high-quality relationship, as I said earlier, is one in which you're already good to yourself, because I find - and I'm not answering the question, but I'm answering it from the other side - that a relationship that isn't of high quality is one in which one of the two people relies on the other, in the sense, perhaps, of an emotional deficiency, and expects the other to come in and make up for something. For me, that's not a great quality. So in the end, if I were to put it the other way round, it's really a relationship where, in the end, you're already comfortable with yourself, you know what you want, and in fact, the other doesn't come to fill something, the other comes in addition. For me, it's the other person who comes on top and finally, well yeah, that's the bonus. And so, for me, a high-quality relationship is something, it's a relationship that's serene, where there's no, well, there you go, where in fact, we know our place, and in fact, if we want to do things together, and in fact, yeah, doing things as a couple, it has to be, in fact, a harmonious relationship, where in the end, if we're together, it's because we want to be together, it's because we want to make plans, etc. Yeah, there has to be a balance between the two. I have a bit of a problem with the couple, it's all about concessions, I have a bit of a problem with that. For me, a couple is really, yeah, we're free, in fact, everyone's free, in the sense that, well, there's the couple, for me, in the couple, there's a kind of contract somewhere, well, there are rules to respect, we have to agree with that, and in fact, there's no one model of couple for me. My vision of a couple isn't going to be the same as my neighbor's vision, and in fact, that's fine, as long as... In fact, for me, our model has to be, well, that of our couple, in the end. So, from the moment our partner has the same vision as

us, we can be a couple, and in fact, we can move forward together, and as a result, my vision is that we should be free, that we shouldn't force ourselves, free in the sense of, well, freedom, the same, it's up to us to put what we want in freedom, somewhere, because we can talk about a free couple with, well, we have the right to have our partners, for example, sexual partners as well, and so on. That's not how I see it, but that's where it's also very subjective, in the end, because in fact, every couple has its own definition, and what's important is to respect that definition, and to know, in fact, what our definition of a couple is, well, at the outset, what, in the end, and perhaps to remind ourselves - that's what I tell myself for my couple, in the end - that it almost seems important to take stock, in the end, I think that in long relationships, it's important, in the end, to perhaps take stock, well, when we need it and when we feel, in fact, that we're no longer, perhaps, in the same car, let's say, and to see, well, can we be born again or do we need to separate, etc.? , whatever. So, yeah, for me, my vision of the couple is going to be in a certain way, but for the other person, it might not be that vision, so it's very subjective. For me, there's no such thing as an ideal couple. My ideal couple, maybe I could define it, and even then, it's complicated, I find, but the vision I want to have, it's not going to be the vision of another couple. After all, I think that we're human beings and that we're, well, there are rules to respect, respect, well, respect, no violence, no violence, well, physical, etc., and in any case, from the moment when, even if we don't have the same vision of the couple, from the moment when one of us doesn't agree, well, it's not good, it's not harmonious. So there you have it, my vision of the couple may be somewhat different, but I think that in all couples, there are things that come together in the end, but a bit like general rules of life, in fact. There are some things you just don't do, you know, you don't kill, you don't rape, you don't torture, you know, these are pretty basic things, and they're bound to be found in a couple, for me, and I think in general, I hope, I hope for everyone, but it's true that for me, if I had to say, it's to be, well, to really keep this free will and this freedom, and to be, well, to be in agreement, finally, with what we want, what, our projects, to be in the discussion, that's really, in fact, we hear it everywhere, it's a bit clichéd, but it's so true, communication, what, to have a fluid communication, to say, well, when we need, what we need, in fact, us first, before blaming the other, that's kind of my vision, my vision of the couple, my ideal vision of the couple, but at the same time, yeah, I'm pretty convinced, for me anyway, that without that, I'm not safe, I'm not serene, what, and it's not harmonious for me. And that's it. Yeah, so for you, a good quality would be a couple that's harmonious and respectful. Yes, harmony, respect, and yeah, respect, in fact, for each other's freedom and limits, and that's it, it's knowing that we finally have common goals and projects, and that we want to accomplish them together. And when would you say that your relationship has been the most harmonious or respectful? The most harmonious and the most respectful? Yes, I would. But I don't know, it's hard to say. In fact, I have the impression that, well, I've been in a relationship for [16-20] years now, and even when I look back and say to myself "ok, I was very happy then, I was very much in love", I can't help wondering, saying to myself "yes, but I was operating in a different way all the same, and I was dating, I was a young adult, and so I also had mechanisms, in fact, of...". I've been working on myself for a long time now, and I'm really questioning myself, and I've made a lot of progress on why I acted the way I did, etc., and as a result, I can see things, mechanisms that I may have had when I was younger and in my relationship, with my current partner, since it was him, that may not have been very healthy in the end, well, somewhere. Afterwards, I don't feel guilty about it, and I don't say to myself "well, that's because you were like that", and I don't look at it badly, I don't look at that period badly, but I say to myself "ok, I was super happy, etc., I'd like to, there are things,

sensations I'd like to find again, etc., with my partner, but for all that, that's not why I'd necessarily like to be the person I was at that time". So, after that, I'd say that the periods when I was happiest and when things were most harmonious for me in our relationship, were periods when we were already communicating, when communication was easier, and when, to put it bluntly, without blaming my partner, and where my partner was more able to question himself, perhaps, to communicate about his feelings, and not necessarily about his negative feelings, in fact, if I feel bad or whatever, but even about his feelings, even towards me, for example, and as a result, there was more communication even in relation to that. And afterwards, I wonder, I also wonder to what extent, precisely, all the experience we've had can interfere with that, because today, I have the impression that somewhere there have been wounds and resentment, sometimes, perhaps, accumulated, etc., even if we try to... Me, in particular, because it's me, generally, who triggers one of the discussions, we try to talk about it, to talk about it to try, precisely, to externalize it. Yeah, I wonder to what extent that doesn't play into it, actually. A bit like with our loved ones, for example, our parents, our brothers and sisters, where in the end, we've been through so much that there are times when we can't really be... Well, it interferes and even darkens everything we'd like to say, all the positive things we'd like to say. There's this thing, a bit like a ball and chain that follows us, and we say to ourselves "yeah, but that's what happened anyway, so I don't feel like it". I know that there are two of us in a relationship, that I have my faults and so on. Yes, there are things I want to do more, make more of an effort, and so on. Afterwards, I also know why I feel more like it, and I verbalize it. But yes, I'd say that for me, it's the times when my partner was more into trusting me and really letting go of "ok, maybe not the fear of being judged, actually". So, that's where I also have my role, well, my "faults" in the fact that, well, I'm the other person, and as a result, sometimes, given that I'm not necessarily the best communicator, I tend to be a little aggressive, and I understand that he's going to shut down, for example. I mean, he might not feel confident, and so on. So, that's where I also have my share of responsibility. And as a result, yes, well yes, in the end, this communication, when it wasn't in fact altered by experiences and grudges that were a bit, well, gripes that he might have against me, etc. And even less on my side. And even less on my side. So there you have it, because in the end, today, there are things I don't want anymore because, in fact, they've accumulated, and they're just there. And I can't say to myself "ok, well, this is good, the present moment is here, so here it is". But yeah, that's because the experience, the fears, all of a sudden, it puts filters on us, and so on. I get the impression that's what it's all about. Yes, yeah, so those were the times when there was more communication, more trust, as you said. And more exchanges. Yes, more exchanges, but unbiased exchanges. Unbiased by all those experiences and complicated moments.

I: And on the contrary, when is it the direct opposite, when does it happen?

P: Yes, that's right, it's when you're going through a period in your life when things are already complicated for you individually, and you end up transposing it onto the other person. And then, when things don't work out in many areas, you come home and there it is. And the first person you're going to empty it out on is your spouse, your family. Well, it's the spouse, because I think we have this thing with our children where we have a bit more of a filter, well, even more of one. Well, it depends on the expectations we have too, even if I think we need to get away from that, the expectations we have of our spouse. In spite of everything, in terms of our vision of the couple, my vision is also... I do expect things of my partner, in terms of his attitude and his... yeah, in his way of

being and actually welcoming certain things in me, I think. I'm aware of that, but at the same time, yeah, at the same time, it would be really useful, I think, and relevant to tell him about it and really set the record straight about what my expectations are and whether it's up to him to meet them or whether he feels it's up to him, etc. But yeah, me, for example, I'm not sure about my expectations, but I'd like to know what they are. But yeah, me, for example, in my ideal vision of the couple, I expect my partner to welcome, to listen, but not to find me a solution. I know he's trying to find solutions, but yeah, that kind of listening and just welcoming, okay, I'm not feeling well, you see, there you go, welcome it, but I don't need you to... but I don't need you to comfort me, just a physical contact that I don't necessarily have, and so, it's true that this, in the end, is a mechanism that's also put in place and, as a result, it generates frustration, sadness, anger afterwards, and this means that, put all together, in the end, lots of little things like this, plus afterwards with the child, tiredness, etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., educational differences, well, educational differences. Even if we're on the same wavelength on a lot of things, there are times when we don't agree, and that creates divergences and imbalances, and so, yes, it all adds up, and that's what makes it so that we're not... well, that it's more harmonious, that we don't understand each other anymore. That we don't understand each other anymore, but because, I think, the mode of communication isn't the right one, that we don't take the time to and that, well, in the end, and it's insidious afterwards because it's... it's also afterwards, it's a bit servile, it's a bit like the snake biting its own tail, you know. So, yeah, it's those moments when, finally, we don't know how to talk to each other, we don't know how to listen to each other, we're very self-centered, finally, and in fact, yeah, we forget to listen to the other and welcome what the other also has to say to us, what. Yes, yeah, I see.

I: So, we've been talking about harmony, respect, communication and trust, among other things, and I'd like you to tell me if there are any other things that are important to you in your relationships?

P: Yes. Well, for me, yes, it's attention too, for me, it's important all the same, even if we're two free, independent beings, whatever we want, in the end too, I find, despite everything, that self-confidence and self-esteem also come through, despite everything, we're human beings, so it comes through the gaze of others, of the other, in any case, of those we esteem, and when we're in a relationship, we esteem the person we're with, in principle, for me, that's where it starts, we esteem them, we love them, and as a result, there's a mirror effect that's created, and in fact, yeah, for me, in a couple, when you love someone, when you esteem someone, you want, you want to have attentions, attentions that can be in the, how to say, in the, physically, in fact, really in the gestures, etc., but also, yes, in a word, so yes, the attention, in fact, the attention that we can pay to the other, that's, I think it's important, well, it's important to me, in any case, and I expect it from my partner, effectively, but yes, I think it's important, in fact, that in a couple, in particular, and even in love in general, I have the impression that we tend to say, okay, what I give, well, I want the same thing, or, well, I want someone to give me that, and, in fact, without giving anything, well, I don't know, I think it's, well, it's important, in fact, to know how to give without necessarily expecting exactly the same thing, because understanding that the other person doesn't necessarily have the capacity to give it, and at the same time, yeah, that's it, it works for both, it can work for me and for my partner, but really, I'd like to be able to really give it without expecting the same thing from him, and I'd also like him to be able to do the same thing, at least not at the same time, well,

there you go, even if, there you go, I, that's limited too, well, there you go, it can't be one-sided too, what, it's not always the same person who, but on the other hand, understanding that there are times when you're able to do it and the other isn't, and vice versa, but it's true that on the other hand, yes, it has to be, in fact, what's important for me, is really the balance, anyway, what, that there isn't, that there isn't this thing of, it's always the same person who gives, somewhere, well, that's it, and that it isn't, in any case, a constraint and a, how can I say, a, yeah, an obligation that you don't feel forced to give, that it's not, that you don't force yourself, what, that it's still, for me, it's also that, yeah, it's that it's fluidity, really, that it's logical, well, yeah, very fluid, what, there you go, that it's, from the moment you really force yourself, etc. I'm not saying that, there you go, it's that, it's that, it's that, it's that, it's that, it's that. I'm not saying that, you know, there are times when you feel less, you can sometimes be, feel a little less, a little less, yeah, feel a little more forced, even if, you know, I used to have trouble with that, you know, I say to myself, if from the moment you feel forced, there's a problem, you know. And so, it's a bit complicated, but at the same time, I say to myself, well, it could also be, well, there you go, we're, we have our, well, there are lots of things that can come into play, hormonally, in terms of, yeah, because we're tired, etc., and that as a result, it's not always, it's, there you go, we don't always have the same enthusiasm, the same desire, etc. But, at the same time, yeah, if it's redundant and we feel forced to, it's not natural, it's not fluid, well, there, I ask myself questions, and these are questions I'm asking myself, in my relationship, what, right now, what. Saying to myself, ok, well, there's a kind of notion of habit that can be very heavy at some point. So, even if I really don't think I'm part of the team, okay, it's over, it's good, it's categorical, we're separating, because, well, otherwise, we wouldn't have been together for so long. But, yeah, there's this real question, you know, it's this notion of habit that can be almost harmful, in fact. I mean, routine can be very comfortable and reassuring. But, yeah, I think there's a plateau where, at some point, it just doesn't make sense anymore. So I think you really have to ask yourself the right questions. Why do we stay together? Is it because we're used to it? Is it because, well, there's the child, there's the family, there's the idea, and then there's the dreamed or idealized or fantasized family pattern. But, yeah, this thing of saying, are we staying because we love each other? Are we staying because we don't want to destroy our family? Do we still have the energy to stay together and feel good? Well, there you go, there's also the notion, well, when I say, you've already got to feel good about yourself. At some point, she asks herself this question. Yes, to the habit, yes, to the family, to everything you're going to lose by leaving the person. Well, in any case, by separating. But there's also your personal well-being. And I think that's really important. And for everyone. For yourself, for your relationship, well, for the quality of your relationship. And the quality of the relationship in your family too, with your children. And then, even beyond that, there's the family pattern. OK, we don't want to destroy it, but if we fight all the time, and if, well, even if it's not described, violent things, etc., they're not fooled. They can see it. So, what else do we want to show and learn, to show our children what it's like to be a couple? And precisely, so that they can build healthy relationships afterwards. Me, my daughter, when she's old enough to have a love relationship that's... What does it... What does it mean for her, in fact, to love herself? Because, well, there are lots of things to think about afterwards, but it's even more important when you have a child. And I know that, yes, if I didn't have my daughter today, I wouldn't be asking myself the same questions. That's a factor. I think that... Yeah, I really wonder to what extent I wouldn't already be separated from my partner. So that's really... And that raises questions. You think, well, it's... At the same time, you think, well... I mean, if I judge myself, I don't

want to judge myself, but if I look outside, I say to myself, well, yeah, but at the same time, well, it's more sensitive for my daughter because I'm asking myself real questions, but at the same time, well, in fact, if I have the answer and I say to myself, if I didn't have my daughter, I'd already be separated from my partner, it's still... Yeah, it's kind of questioning. It's questioning. Yes, it is. In fact, right now, I'd like you to tell me what love is in general, based on your experiences, your background and so on. It could be love in a relationship, love in a friendship... Right, OK. That was my question. So, love in a couple, I think we've got it pretty well worked out. It's really about respecting each other, paying attention to each other, the desire to have joint projects, fluidity, humour, complicity, that's it, and trust. And then, if I broaden it out, in the end, I get the impression that all these values are transposed into friendship. So, for me, the only thing that differs from friendship is the carnal side, physical contact and sexual relations. But actually, yeah, I'm really transposing that to friendship, in the end. Even though there's an extra dimension to love, because it's nothing you live with every day. And that's even more challenging, I'd say, because it's harder. You can be the best of friends and still have all those values of complicity and respect. There's a notion too, I didn't say it, but of consideration, of admiration almost, somewhere. But without putting the other person on a pedestal. But yeah, admiration. But then, I'd also like to say that what we admire in the other person, in a way, is what we also have in ourselves. There's something of that too. It's something we have inside us that we'd like to develop, or that we haven't developed, or at least we have. So, somewhere, there's that too. But yeah, all the notions I've just mentioned, in love ultimately, and really loving relationships, couples, well yes, I find them, that's what I cultivate, in quotation marks, or what I find in my friendly relationships. But without the really challenging dimension of living with it, because that's a very special dimension indeed. So, in the end, it's not so easy. I find that in friendship, it's simpler, in a way, because, well, you don't go home with that person in the evening. But they can still be there, because you can maybe call them, communicate with them, or him, or whatever. But there isn't that dimension of being with him all the time. I mean, when you're in a couple, or in any case, our vision of a couple is to live under the same roof, which is my case. Yeah, there's definitely that difference with friendship. But for all that, yeah, friendship, in the same way as love, for me anyway, is really about being yourself. I'd really separate friendship, real friendship, from relationships, acquaintances, work, which is a bit more superficial. In the end, I think a lot of us are in a role that's a bit, our ideal role, a bit idyllic, etc., from what we actually are. So, yeah, it's really something to dissociate. But it's really about being able to be yourself, and being loved, respected and considered as you really are. Not hiding, not playing games. To really be yourself. To have the freedom to be yourself, and to be loved for it. For me, friendship is really the same as love for that, really. And if I had to extend it to family, for example, well, I'd like to, it would really be in an ideal world, I'd like it to be the same thing, but then it's something else again. The stakes for me are completely different. There are so many things that come into play. The affect, as we used to say, the long relationship I would associate with family life. Where, at a given moment, there's a history that can be loaded, that's quite long-lasting. And in fact, yeah, despite everything, I get the impression that it's pretty recurrent in families. In the end, yeah, there are a lot of families where it's not like that. We can get along fine, but there are always little things behind it. And there are always underlying wounds and things. So there are families where it's totally swept under the carpet and in fact we know all about it but we don't talk about it. There are families where it's going to explode and then, well, it gets better, but in fact it's still there all the same, that's all. And that's just human nature, we communicate, that's all. But there are also family patterns, just as there are

couple patterns and the vision of the family, but that's the same for everything. The values we attribute to each thing, in the end, are very different from one person to another. And in the family, it's something else again. It's really a kind of organization that's specific to each family and even to each child, I'd like to say. I come from a family where there are three of us, three girls, and we're... We grew up in the same family, we have the same parents, we share a common history, but for all that, we don't have the same feelings, we don't have the same expectations, in quotation marks, of what we'd like our relationships to be with each other, with our parents, that's all. So family is something else again. I find it even more complicated because, in fact, we exchange, we live with them, with all the history we have, with the child we were, the adult we've become. It's very, very special. And what's more, with individuals who, like us, have their own experiences, not necessarily in the family, but even their own experiences in their own family, and so on. And people, in fact, can't be exchanged. So that's the difficulty, really, in the same way. It's true that, in the end, we tend to surround ourselves with people who may or may not be good for us, depending on the pattern, but for me, in any case, I'm going to say to myself, ok, my friends, I've chosen them and, in fact, I've chosen them today, they're good for me and they're going to bring me the things I need, and I can bring things that, at the end of the day, bring me something from the relationship, because in the end, we're all individualistic beings, even if we don't really like that term, in the way society is, we're very individualistic, but yes, we're individuals and so we each have our personalities, etc., and to grow, to evolve, we need to be able to see each other, to be able to see ourselves, to be able to see ourselves. But yes, we're individuals, so we each have our own personality, etc., and to grow, evolve and move forward in life, we need to feed off things. It's a bit simplistic to say that, but that's what it's all about. And yes, as a result, I, my friends, as a result, yes, I'm going to choose them somewhere, or in any case, they're going to choose me, or in any case, we're going to choose each other in such a way that it's all for the good. In the family, it's a bit different, and as in the couple, when it lasts like this over time, at the beginning, everything's beautiful, it's only the positive that we want to draw out, but afterwards, there's all the history and then our personalities, and so on. So it can be the same in a long-term friendly relationship too, but the friendly dimension is always the same, you can't live with it. If you want to break up, I think it's easier too, there's less at stake, even if there is, and it can still be very painful to break up as friends, but there's another dimension to it, I think, really. And in the family, it's the same, but in fact, these values I mentioned at the beginning, ideally, ideally, but that's a bit utopian, I'd like to find them in all the relationships I meet, and the one I come from in the end, which is my family. But that's a bit utopian, unfortunately, and it's all a work in progress for me to manage to be in acceptance and less in affect, so as to live it better and give meaning to what others are.

I: And how important would you say a loving relationship is?

P: It's at the heart of it, really. After that, people make a big deal out of love... I have the impression that there are some people who... Love is the thing, the grail, the forbidden word in fact. For me, love is all the time, love is in a lot of things. I'm full of gratitude, it's love, without being too philosophical. Some people are afraid of love, but love doesn't scare me. And yet, I think I have a very peaceful relationship with love in the end, I have no trouble telling people I love them, really. And I don't feel that it commits me completely, and it's not taboo for me. And yet, I grew up in a family where, in the end, it wasn't said, it wasn't verbalized. I've always felt that I was... In fact, I don't feel loved but not valued, so that's another thing, my place in my family etc. and my

experiences. But at the same time, I know deep down that there is love. The thing is, since we don't all define love in the same way, and we don't all express it in the same way, and we don't all expect the same thing from love, that's where we sometimes don't understand each other. But it's true that for me, it's not a big word that scares me, and that's that. I don't have a problem with it. I say it a lot. I used to say it a lot with my partner. Today, I say it less because I feel the love of love, the love of a couple. I feel I feel it less, and in fact, I feel I'm lying. I feel affection for him today. I love him all the same, and to say "I love you" to him, and to have the impression that it's like all the "I love you" I've said to him before, which were really very intense, very thoughtful, very deep, and that I think that for him it's really... well, it has that meaning. It's true that I tend not to tell him, not to verbalize it to him. For all that, I love him, but not in a physical way, but in a loving way, I think. I still love him, but no longer with that kind of love, almost family love, which is finally said, but not really said anymore. So there's a difference between "I have no trouble saying I love you" and "I have no trouble saying I love you when I mean it in love". But it's true that when it comes to my partner, I've got this thing where I don't tell him anymore, or even tell him less, because I don't feel the way I used to with him. But it's true that I almost feel like I need two last words. No, because it's love all the same, but it's nuanced all the same. When I say "I love you" to my lover, it's not the same "I love you" that I'll say to my friends and my daughter. So, yeah, almost, you'd have to have another word. No, well no, you wouldn't have to have another word, but in any case, that's why I say it less to my partner, because I feel less of this love for him. Even though I love him for everything he is, everything he's been, everything he means to my daughter, everything he's meant to me in my life, etc. But yeah, that's another thing. But yeah, that's special too, it's questioning in a way. I say that, but I'm not sure we need another word, because everything is love, but that's where it can get a bit confusing in the end, because in fact, we put a lot of things in the love box. And so, yeah, we might tend to mix things up, well, mix them up, even if they do come together, and they're feelings that can come together, but it's something that needs to be nuanced, I think. And you've touched on the question I'm about to ask you. You yourself said that there are different, already different forms of love, different ways of expressing it on people. So I'd like to know how do you know that your partner loves you, how does he show it, how do you see it? So, how do I know or how would I like him to show it? How do you know? How do I know? Well, I don't know. That's a real question I've been asking myself lately, and the fact that we've been thinking about it, that I've been talking about separation and so on. Because it's really a question I've been asking myself, because I don't feel it, I don't see it. And I'm really wondering if that's the case. Because in the same way that I don't seem to feel it anymore, I don't feel the question of love, well, and by his lack of gestures, his... He's told me, he's told me, he's told me several times now, but is it my filters? And then, because I think that, I project it onto him, and then these gestures that he doesn't have or doesn't have anymore, and the intention that I don't think is there anymore, and the desire that... In fact, it's a whole package in the end. Yeah, I think that really, apart from the demonstration of what was love before between us, I think that really it's a feeling, I don't know how to say it, it's a very intuitive feeling, I have the impression that it's intuitive, yeah. I really feel that... Because you can say it, but in fact, if it sounds false, or if you don't really feel it inside, yeah, I'm not convinced. So today, that's really it. Yeah, is he trying to convince himself by telling me, or verbalizing it, etc., or is he really feeling it? Because I have the impression that I feel it more, and that I know him a lot, I know him well, even if you're never inside a person's head. But today, from everything we've been through, I have the impression that he doesn't feel it. And that, effectively, it's still going to be everyday gestures, and initiative-

taking, and there you go, it's things he's going to do in our life as a couple, or... well, that are absent, well, and certainly important things, there you go, from my point of view as a couple, that aren't there or aren't there anymore, and so, there you go, that make me say but in fact, I have the impression that he's also lying to himself whatsoever. So you're already feeling this, perhaps through a lack of certain gestures? Yes, yes, certainly, yes, yes, of course. Of course, in fact, it's a... but that's where it gets complicated. Is it an interpretation? Because I feel it? Or is it, but yes, yes, it's more like that. It's the absence in fact, the absence of affectionate gestures, the absence of taking the initiative in, well, our life as a couple or our family life, but well, it's really going to be about the couple. Yes, yes, that's exactly it. But the risk is in the interpretation. Because when communication isn't good, that's where the difficulty lies. When communication isn't good, well, and then at the same time he can tell me what he wants, but yeah, that's another value to add for me, it's honesty, frankness, it's really being yourself, being true in fact, being true, really being yourself. And not, yes, not to be another person with the person you're dealing with, because otherwise, well, communication is distorted, it's biased, you don't know what the other person's feeling. And that's that. So in fact, I know he loves me if he tells me so, yes, but if he really means it. And there are a lot of things that make me think that it's not embodied, well, it's not embodied. And that's where I'm talking about my intuition, but because I know him and the fact that he's missing some gestures, etc., I'm not really sure. Well yeah, for me, there's no love after all. But then, it's even more insidious and more, well, more, how can I say, more precise than that, well. And it's really going to be, in the end, wasn't it already the way we worked and it suited me before and it's today that I think that, finally. So, in fact, it puts a lot of things back into perspective and into question. So yes, today, as I would interpret it in relation to our history, in relation to his character, in any case from what I know of him and what I would like, it's the absence of gestures and the absence of sincerity that I feel. So that's intuition or interpretation, but is it the truth? But is it the truth? But I do know that he loves me if he really embodies it. If deep down I feel, I feel that it's sincere. And indeed, if he shows it, yes, with gestures, but that's not everything. And because, for example, he still verbalizes it, but I don't believe it. It's more subtle than that. Yeah, it's really that, yeah. I'd like you to tell me about one of the last positive interactions you had. Any last positive interactions? Honestly, maybe the last one I can think of was when we had a laugh. I don't even know why, but I have this image where it was actually very light-hearted. We looked at each other, we laughed, we don't know what it was, but it was really sincere. It's a very silly, simple and harmless thing. But actually, no, it's not. I think it's also what I miss in our daily lives. In the end, it's lightness. I think it's a bit too serious in the sense that the tone is serious. And that was an interaction I liked. In fact, I liked the fact that we weren't afraid of what the other person was going to think, that we weren't over-interpreting each other's ideas, because I think I'm over-interpreting too. So, a moment like that was yesterday. We laughed about something, but it really wasn't fair. We laughed because it happens to us a lot. Our daughter clowns around and we laugh. But because even that, we laugh, but we don't look at each other tenderly and say, well, it's still... No, even that's not our everyday life. And then, I don't know, it was really something to do with the little one, but I don't even know anymore. But I don't know, I have this image. And then, a little more concretely, but then, yeah, again it's disappointment. In fact, we arranged to meet not so long ago after our respective jobs. My sister was even taking care of our daughter. And in fact, just to find an hour in a neutral place to meet up and talk. And in fact, we said we'd do it once a month. And now, yes, I'm disappointed. I'm still the one who initiated this. If I don't do it now, in the end, it's not

done. So, in fact, it's something that tires me. So I don't feel like it anymore. I don't feel like making the effort, and I don't even feel like making the effort, because I see that afterwards, the discussion doesn't work out, that we don't rearrange the subjects, and so on. So in fact, we're in a mood where I'm getting bored. But on the other hand, that moment was great because I really had the impression that we were going to a neutral place to be alone or just the two of us. I was even a bit excited, thinking "ok, I'm getting ready, I'm going to see my husband". We just went for a coffee, we didn't go to a hotel. But all of a sudden, I'm really thinking "that's great, we're going to get together, I'm going to find him...". I feel like I haven't seen him all day, but he's not coming home, so it's different. I'm going to find him beautiful, I make myself beautiful for him. There was definitely that thing, a bit of an image. And what's more, he said to me, "I thought you were so beautiful when you came home". And I thought "wow, it's been a really long time since he said that to me". And now it's running out of steam. I feel like that's it. That's the story of our relationship over the last few years, that it's running out of steam. We don't feel like it anymore, we don't have the energy or the "strength", because we're tired of our daily lives as parents, of all the things that happen to us professionally, and so on. In fact, we just don't feel like it anymore. And that's kind of what happens. So, yeah, it's moments like that that are great, but each time, it's my initiative. And that's it. Well, that's just for the record. But yeah, it's the moment when, finally, we need to take time out together again, we know it, we want to at some point, but in fact, yeah, as I was saying earlier, if the initiative comes more from one side, it runs out of steam, in fact. And that's what happens. And for example, if we go back to the moment when you said you'd laughed, which was also positive interaction, what was it that you were doing, this positive interaction side? Lightness, really. It was really... And I think that's what we're missing too, living in the moment. I mean, it's a very trivial thing, in the moment, but really a very silly thing. But it was sincere. There was sincerity in that moment. And I think that's what it is, yeah. It's a bit of... In fact, it's the day-to-day rhythm of our lives, which means that we're in a kind of whirlwind, but on a lot of things, not just on the couple, but it's true that yes, the couple too, at the end of the day. And in fact, we have the impression that it's an effort to make, to take time together. And that's what it's all about. Here, what was nice and pleasant was this sort of thing where okay, it's the moment T and in fact, we take advantage of this moment and it's light. And that's what we need to bring back into our daily lives, but it's not so easy to do. And that's it, that's lightness. Lightness and the present moment. Living in the moment. Which I really don't think we do enough of, that's the first thing. Right, yeah.

I: So, I'm really sorry, I'm going to interrupt quickly, because I've got an appointment after lunch.

P: I'm in.

I: Actually, I just don't feel like starting the next part and interrupting in the middle. So, I wanted to know, will you be free, for example, this afternoon to continue later or not?

P: So, yes, how long would it take? I've been talking a lot, haven't I?

I: Don't worry about it. Really, it's very interesting. I'm not allowed to bounce or interact with you, so I can't show, but it'll be super interesting. But it stays, it stays, it stays, I don't know what, it looks like at least half an hour, maybe [1-5] months plus. And then there are some questionnaires to go through. But that's why we could continue with the discussion, but I don't want to cut in the middle of a game.

P: Okay, no worries. But then, I don't know when... Afterwards, as you wish, because if you want, I'll talk less.

I: Oh no, no, not at all, on the contrary, it's super interesting. It's just that, when you schedule appointments, you never know how long...

P: Of course, I understand, I understand. OK, if you think it's going to take a bit longer then, this afternoon, what's best for you, when are you available?

I: I'd say I'll be available from 3:30 onwards. 15h30 ?

P: From 3:30, normally, I should be available. OK.

I: If it's 3:30, that can do it for me. After that, I've got my daughter to pick up at 4:30. So, if yes, if we... If you tell me it'll take about half an hour, well, three quarters of an hour, that should do it.

P: Yes, normally. Yes ? I'm talking less, I've already said two things a lot.

I: No, there's nothing to worry about. No, but I know, I know you're not blaming me. But I also know that I talk a lot. It's interesting stuff, there's no... For you, there's no... I apologize for really... No, no, no worries. There's no problem, don't worry. But then, if you want 3pm... If we give you an appointment at 3:30, that's fine with me.

P: All right, then I'll make it 3:30.

I: Great. I don't know if the link will work, but we'll send a new one.

P: Okay, by e-mail?

I: Yes. Works.

P: Okay, let's do it.

I: Great, thank you very much.

P: You're welcome.

PART 2

I: It's the application that's not for you. Okay, so that's good. So, yes, you told me about your last positive interaction. Could you tell me about the last negative interaction you had with your partner? I'm sorry, maybe the warm-up is a bit...

P: No, no, don't worry. No problem at all. Last negative interaction... Actually, I don't know if it's really negative... Last interaction, then, where it's... For me, what seemed negative, in the end, were interactions that weren't very... Not very... A bit disappointing. It's not even necessarily when there's going to be an altercation, in fact. But it's more like that. It's more like, yeah, well, we've talked, but there's no change. Yeah, but that's what it comes down to, is that I'm waiting. But yeah, it's going to be more like that, actually. So... Yeah, in fact, it's as soon as I stop for two seconds and

realize, what. Of, well, the nature of our relationship today. Of... Yeah, of, well, a lot of dysfunction, shall we say, in our relationship. And that, in the end, well... We're burying ourselves in it. So, it's more than, ultimately, a really negative interaction. In the sense that, you know, it's a clash, or something. It's not necessarily that, for me. So, in fact, it's a bit of a daily thing, I'd say. Because, well, it's a bit like that, a bit like the disappointment of, well, our relationship. And here we are, and in fact, I don't think he's really dissuaded by it. Ok, ok, right, yeah.

I: Yeah. I'd like you to tell me about the challenges in your relationship.

P: There have been, a lot. Today, yes, the challenge is... The big challenge, in the end, is staying together. That's really the challenge, because that's the big question. And so, yes, it's a challenge, but at the same time... It's not really... I mean, for me, a challenge is something that's in front of us, that we have to overcome. I don't know, actually, me, today, really... I don't know if I feel like taking up this challenge. Challenges aren't my thing either, so there you go. So, yeah, it's a challenge in the sense that, in the end, staying together for a long time, yes, it's a challenge. I think it's a challenge for everyone. So, yeah, maybe that's what it would be, but then again, challenges aren't really my thing. And at the same time, for me, it shouldn't be. I mean, even if, as I said this morning, life is winding, and it's never all black and white, but it's true that, yeah, I find it... It's a bit exhausting to tell myself that it's a challenge. So there you go, I don't know, yeah, I'm not much of a challenge. At the same time, I tell myself that, in a way, I'm making sure that I'm careful and that I don't go in headlong or give up completely, because otherwise, I wouldn't still be here, I think, as a couple, and weighing up the pros and cons all the time. But yeah, in the end, that's probably it, actually. The challenge is to stay together. And you mentioned that you may have taken up some of these challenges in the past.

I: What would that challenge be?

P: Yeah, it's to always be on the same wavelength, in fact, to always manage to communicate, to understand each other, in fact, to always manage to understand each other, in the end, and to always manage to be honest, what, because, well, I talked this morning, for example, about the deception that happened in our couple. I think these are things, so maybe we also had to, well, I'm trying to make sense of it by telling myself that it was something to live through, but at the same time, do we really need to go through this? I'm not sure. But I do think that, in a way, this kind of thing could be avoided if we managed to communicate in a healthy and honest way. So, in fact, it's a daily challenge for couples to understand each other, to be able to communicate well, to understand each other, and then to be on the same wavelength and, at some point, to readjust each other. Yes, yes. Also, as before, you spoke to me about clashes, you quickly touched on the term "clash". Talking, perhaps, about the fact that it's never exactly in the vault any more, and so on.

I: But then, I'd like you to tell me, are there any bells and whistles, perhaps, in your relationship?

P: Yes, yes, totally, totally. And it's true that, yes, if, if, of course there are clashes, I was saying that, in fact, there, for example, my last moments, a little, yeah, not very harmonious, well, it's not necessarily when it goes to clash, in fact. But we go to clash, that's clear. And then, I find that, well, it's a question of individual character too. For example, in concrete terms, I'm going to try to communicate, so in fact, I'll be communicating a lot, and maybe, as a result, he'll take it as I'm

teasing him, and until he... I'll take the glasses out of his nose, you know, a little bit. And so, it's true that we clash over things like that. But at the same time, for me, it's always simpler than clashing, because... and the problem we've had in recent years is that I think I'm much more careful, and I'm less impulsive, but in the end, well, in fact, he prefers, in a way, but when it really comes to clashing, it... well, it stirs up a lot of things, and as a result, it's almost more violent, in a way, I think. And then, it's mainly that, finally, I realize... well, at the same time, I say to myself, well, I'm rather pleased with myself and proud of myself, and even, I feel better for being less impulsive too, but I know that these last few years, there, it's also... I take it to heart. So, for the time being, this is where I'm more in tune with myself, and in fact, under cover of him, at least, he remains in denial and buries his head in the sand, the clashes are even more violent, I find. So, yes, of course it's going to clash, that's clear. It goes to the clash, and then it also depends on each person's day. I mean, it's very... in the end, it's very dependent on our mood, in fact, and everything we've been through during the day, during the week, our level of fatigue, etc., what have you. But, yeah, we're... at the same time, it's good to be... to put ourselves first, but at the same time, it's complicated, because when you live as a couple, there are two of you, and it's important to take the other person into consideration. So it's really the ambivalence, I find, of the couple, really. And when these clashes occur, how do you feel about couples? The problem is that, yes, in fact, the clashes often come afterwards, with an explosion, in the end, especially on my side. I trigger a discussion, well, if we manage to resolve them, well, resolve them, in any case, calm things down and explain ourselves afterwards, it's because I triggered a discussion. And, as a result, we manage to discuss things a little afterwards, but unfortunately, things don't... well, my message isn't heard, maybe it's not said in the right way, or at least received in the right way, I think there's a bit of both. So, in fact, yes, it can be resolved, in quotation marks, because we discuss it, but in the end, we realize that there are lots of things like that where it's not resolved. And then, today, in the situation we're in today, it's clear that these clashes haven't been resolved. After all, in the past, yes, every time we've clashed, it's been through discussion, in any case, it's been through communication and also the fact of recognizing one's faults and apologizing, which isn't really the case in our relationship these last few years. But yes, if I go back a bit, that was our way of operating, just as I think our relationship was also harmonious, balanced, because we recognized what the other did, without it being an obligation or something we said to ourselves, I must thank him, or whatever. In fact, it was very natural for us to thank each other for a little thing we'd done together, but really, sometimes, just around the house. Thank you for taking out the rubbish, thank you for doing the dishes, those kinds of things that seem very trivial, but in fact were actually quite healthy, quite important, and we don't do them anymore. Yes, but in the end, it was communication that made it possible to, and even today, perhaps solve a fundamental problem. Yes, in the end, what really solves the problem is communication, that's clear. Communication and work, in fact, on oneself, I think, at this stage, well us, in any case, in our couple, the stage we're at, yes, it's really important to recognize oneself, to know what we want, in fact, before the image we want to give to society, to our loved ones, our family, before the "yes, I have to do this because I'm the man of the family" or the perfect mother, or whatever, yeah.

I: So, I'd like to know what other ways you can take care of your relationship?

P: Well, for me, I think that spending time together is what could really make it possible for us to find each other again, and that too sounds very cliché, very cliché, when you hear it around us,

because I think that, as much as we are, I was the first to hear it and I still hear it, and that's it, and in fact, it's clearly that, it's about finding each other again, It's not a dedication to [partner]ny, but it's really that, it's the desire to have the desire before saying, ok, to spend time together, for example, to take our example, at the beginning, there, of, well, after the birth of our daughter, etc.. , when we, well, already, it was very complicated to do it because, no relay, etc., so very complicated to be really just the two of us, but it could very well have been, finally, I don't know, when she went to bed, in the evening, even if it was one hour, to see TV, to be able to meet up, etc., but there was already a real sense of unease and grievances against each other, that we didn't really want to, there's really this thing, it's not, you just have to say to each other, we're taking time together, it's really about wanting it, and for that to happen, yeah, I think we need to do some introspection, to say, okay, I'm in this state right now, but what do I need? and let's each do a bit of introspection on our own, and then, ok, well, I want this, so already, do I need to be alone? But it's true that we've done it when we've been able to leave our daughter, we've done it when we're together, but in fact, it doesn't solve everything, because it does, well, yes, we spend time together, but frankly, I didn't feel like it, well, the first few times, well, at the restaurant, I thought, ah yes, no, but if, and then, then, well, that's what you hear and that's what you tell yourself, too, you say to yourself, ah yes, but come on, you've got to get together, it'll come back, whatever, but in fact, no, not necessarily, at all, because there's all that history behind it, and if we're not on the same wavelength and we haven't communicated and we still don't understand each other, well, in any case, for me, it's not about spending a moment together, an evening together, or even a weekend together, I mean, I'm going to say to myself, okay, that's it, it's still, no, in fact, there are other upheavals that have also taken place, well, there you go, in addition, with [Event], with the child afterwards, there you go, even hormonally speaking, etc.. , When I say hormonal, I'm not just talking about the physical or sexual side, etc., it's really, well, that's what I'm talking about, it's really, well, who I am, so there's a questioning of identity, almost, so, in fact, yeah, there's already this whole phase, I find, and I think it's the same for the co-parent, the father, in this case, well, my partner, where, in the end, we really needed to refocus on ourselves, each of us, to then really want to find each other again. In fact, we kind of forced ourselves into it, and it didn't work out. So, yes, it's time for two, and it's about finding ourselves together, but it's above all a relay, a real relay, in fact, a real relay, already, to manage to get out of your life, for example, the family, in this case, a little out of your thing where you're like that, to already say to yourself, "Ok, now, what do I want, me, as a person?" And then, what, take that time back and, effectively, on the other hand, give it to yourself. When I was talking this morning about a moment for two, where we'd said to each other, here we are, we're getting together without our daughter, and just an hour before going to see her, etc., but here, here, it was really, basically, a moment where we'd said to each other, "Ok, we're getting together, we know it, we want to, and we'll maybe have some discussions, but in any case, here, something where we're really going to get together, and focus on the two of us." But well, in this case, we haven't each, I think, done our introspection, and we're not really telling each other what we want, I think, so it's not working. But yeah, I think it's first of all time for each other, each for ourselves, whether we need it or not, maybe we don't need it, and then afterwards, time for the two of us. Time for just the two of us, in fact, dedicated to the couple. Yeah, totally. Yeah, so it's that balance, again, of having your personal part first, and then being able to join in. Yeah, yeah, totally. Being good to yourself first, yeah. Okay, yeah. On the other hand, let's see what you can do about leaving your partner. Well, inaction, lack of initiative, lack of enthusiasm, in fact, yeah,

almost boredom. The lack of renewal, the feeling of stagnation, in fact. And so, yeah, for me personally, it's a real drag. And I think that, really, basically, I think I already wanted to do it, but I have the impression that I'm... Well, I'm not the one who leads others, I'm generally more of a follower. And in my relationship, in the end, we're both characters where we're more followers, so in fact, I've had to take the lead. And that doesn't suit me. Well, maybe it suited me for the first few years, even if... Well, that's something I used to reproach him for, I think. And in fact, with time, in the end, that too is a myth, but in fact, it's not really a myth. It's that, in the end, the faults become even greater. And sometimes, even the things we liked in the other person, are actually the things that we end up resenting. That's true. So, yeah, that's it, the lack of initiative, the inaction, the... I don't know how else to put it, but... Yes, yes, stagnation, yeah. Yeah, yeah, totally. So, would you say that this relationship is good for you or not? Today, no. Today, no. Well, then, there's a double... There's a double reading. My relationship as it is, no, it's not fulfilling me at all. And I'm clearly aware of that. I've told him, and he's aware of it. Well, it's really a question we ask ourselves and at some point, we're going to have to really, really face up to it. But of course it's a comfort. And, yes, it's a bit... I mean, it's more reassuring to know where you are, even if it's not very comfortable and doesn't make you dream. But then, you can be lucid about it, but do it anyway. And indeed, yes, there's that side where it's comfortable, where ultimately, there's the comfort side of life, financial, not asking too many questions, not telling yourself... That's it, because having the same spouse... Well, in relay with... When you have a child, it's not the same everyday life. We're going to be, I mean, tomorrow. Of course these are questions we ask ourselves, and I said this morning that I don't think I'd be in the same position at all if I didn't have a child with him. Even though there are still things, sometimes shared possessions, things... But yes, of course it's still a daily routine, a habit, which is still... Even if you know it's not ideal, there are things you don't want to leave behind, even in the comfort of your life, like that. And in spite of everything, I'm neither insecure, nor mistreated, nor unhappy either, as much as possible. It's just that there's a lack of dynamism and action. I said it earlier, but that's it. It's not or no longer, in any case, love as I understand it, if we're really talking about love and the couple, a real vision of the couple. And at the same time, I don't want to resign myself to the fact that... That's it, in fact, yes, after [16-20] years together, that's it. And yes, that's how it is. But it's not. That, on the other hand, is what it's all about. But I'm not yet at the stage where I'm over... Well, I'm just saying that, but it's almost the case, anyway. But it's true that there's a material, structural and family comfort, in fact, of balance too for our child. So it's still very complicated, in fact. It's not a spur-of-the-moment decision. Although it wouldn't really be on a whim. I'm really thinking about it, I think, from my point of view.

I: I'd now like to know if you feel you've changed compared to before this relationship, even during the relationship, if you feel you've evolved as a person.

P: Yes, I've evolved as a person, obviously, because we've been together for such a long time. Even though I'm only [31-35], I've still... I've gone from adolescence, let's say young adulthood, to finally, right now, I'm at a stage in my life where I know myself better, etc. But I don't think it's a big deal. But I don't think it's my relationship that's changed me, it's really the evolution of my life, in fact. In fact, my relationship has always been central. In fact, it's been my stability ever since I started working as a young adult, and ever since I moved out of my parents' house. But for all that, it's not my relationship that has... In fact, of course, it's an integral part of my life, so yes, it's played a part, but I wouldn't put it down to my relationship. Even if there have been things that we've lived through

together, or that I've lived through on my own, and the way I've lived through it, it's certainly influenced my path and my choices, well, some of my choices, and in a way, my personality. But I don't think I've changed at all, that's for sure. And I think that, well, it's evolution, actually, but quite logical, given my age. And also, I'm quite... Let's just say I was lucky enough to have a stable couple, in the end, and a relationship in which I thrived, anyway. And it just made sense to me for us to stay together, because things were going so well, and there was no reason to separate. Anyway, there was this deception, and it did call something into question at some point. Well, we'd already been together for [6-10] years, but it was pretty fluid and logical, so for the time being, it didn't influence me. In fact, I really don't have that feeling. Of course, it played a part in my evolution, but because it was my life, in fact, in the same way that, ultimately, the choices I made, in professional terms, etc., influenced me. But I haven't changed from the beginning of my relationship, fundamentally, to now. Yes, I've evolved, but it's not my relationship, really. It's other things that have made me... Well, it's things I've been able to experience, not precisely because I was in a relationship, while I was in a relationship, with my partner in particular. But, for example, motherhood changed me much more than being in a couple. Well, I think it's other things, in fact, that have influenced or influenced my personality, my way of seeing things, etc. It's not my relationship. It's not my relationship. On the contrary, I think it's just that outside things have come to call into question things in my relationship, perhaps. But it's not my relationship per se, no.

I: Do you have the impression that your younger partner has changed too?

P: No, I don't have that impression at all. Afterwards, it's the same thing: you get older. We inevitably change, but I have the impression that for him, it's more external factors that have changed things, perhaps in his way of seeing things, even his personality. So, maybe our relationship has changed things for him, and maybe, for example, my personality has influenced things in him, but we've talked about it, for example, about... It's true that he's always been rather quiet, but not too quiet with me, and it's true that, on the contrary, the communication that was rather fluid, at least from my point of view, before, with him, from him, isn't at all so today, and he told me himself, for example, that at some point he took refuge in his job, and we don't have the same aspirations, and the same priorities, in fact, in our lives. But for him, it's more about work, the professional side, and also, I think a lot, the image he can project, professional success, for example. His job has had a much greater influence on his personality. But maybe, because he took refuge in work, because at a certain point, our relationship... I don't know, maybe so. But like that, I'd say it's more the outside world, in the end, which has influenced us, and which, as a result, is also influencing our relationship. But it's not the couple that's changed us. At least, for me, that's pretty certain. Yes, you've evolved, but it wasn't necessarily due to the couple. No, it wasn't. Not because of our relationship. No. Okay, yeah.

I: I'd like to know if you feel safe, as a result, too, in this relationship.

P: Well, yes, I feel safe, in the sense that, as I said earlier, it's comfortable, it's what I know. Today, I've spent almost as much time with him as without him. So, it's also what I know, and a bit of a comfortable routine. I feel safe because I know that he's a very healthy person, that he's respectful, that he's a good person. So, yes, of course. After that, physical security and even... Yes, physical, well... More physical, yes, of course. Then, as for emotional security, I say to myself, well, as far as I'm concerned, I've clearly told him that he doesn't have the shoulders to take care of me, I have the

impression that he doesn't measure up to what I'd like, to where I'd like him to be. So, in fact, I don't have the emotional response, let's say, that I'm expecting, that I'd like. But for all that, yes, I feel safe. Yes, it's more on the level of attention, comfort, if it's something to share. Yes, it's more on the level of response, well, support, affection, tenderness, that sort of thing, really. Consideration, consideration, yes, really. But otherwise, of course, that, well, I don't feel like going home, that's all. That's why I want to separate these two things, because, of course, it's reassuring, this relationship, but it's true that it's not satisfying, in fact. So, reassuring, yes, satisfying, no. Today, no. Yes, I admit it. So, just now to finish up, I'd like to quickly touch on one last dimension that makes up couples, and that's sexuality. And we know that this dimension is more or less important for different people and couples. And so I'd like to know what it's like for you, what its place is in your relationship. For me, then... For you, yes. And both of you. So, I think we're more or less in agreement, well, we're even, yes, in agreement on that. It's not something that's central and primordial in our relationship. And it's always been more or less, in fact, like that, really, it's something that's present. But at the same time, it's not, well, we don't have any complaints about it. I've never reproached him for that. I've never reproached him for that. And in fact, it's not something that... I mean, it's really not a subject of discord, of dysfunction. We're pretty much in sync, I think... Well, we've always been on the same wavelength in that respect. And it's not the central element in our relationship. At all. Right, yeah.

I: On the other hand, would you say you're satisfied with your... with your sex life?

P: Yes, I'm satisfied with my sex life with him. In this case, today, it's a bit special because I'm more in the mood for tenderness, almost, with him. So, in the end, sexual relations are still quite rare. That's fine with me because it's also in the mood of the moment. So yes, of course I'm fine with it now. A few years ago, it was more frequent and, as I keep saying, it was never the main thing. So, in fact, it's not even a subject for us. That's my point of view. Maybe he won't feel the same way at all. But what's certain is that I've never been reproached. I know that even talking about it with friends, where I really do hear some mind-blowing stuff, really kills me, personally. But as it happens, I think we're very much in agreement on this. I've always thought and felt that way, anyway. And yes, I think we're in agreement on that, and so much the better. And I think that also contributes to my feeling respected in my relationship, in who I am. But no, it's really not... In [16-20] years, it's never been a subject of conflict or reproach. No, it hasn't. Okay.

I: And you were saying that, for the isotherapist, do you ask for the frequency?

P: Well, at the moment, over the last few years, let's say it's once a month.

I: Okay. And that's the end of the questions. And finally, I'm going to show you a scale. I'm going to show you... ... I can't see a thing. Ah! That's it. There. So, if I ask you, in general, my listening partner, how would you put the number of...

P: I'm going to say... Because listening to me, hearing me, is three.

I; Three of you? Three, really.

P: In taking on board what I'm saying to him. So, yeah, three. And why is it three and not two or four? Three, kind of true, yeah, kind of true. Because it's not at all... He hears it, he's able to tell me, there

you go, yes, I know, that's it, that's it. On the other hand, it's about taking things into account, or considering what's been said, and really making sure that it's rectified, or going back on it, and so on. So that's why five would be an average, right?

I: No, yeah, three. Okay. So, now, same thing, so if I ask you, my partner is generally attentive to my needs, from one to nine, what would you put ?

P: Well, I feel like saying the same thing to myself, because it's listening to my needs, so it's the same, is it created or not, what? So, yeah, I'd say three again. And then, the same question of why is it chocolate? Bah, same thing, because it's not at all either, but it hears, it listens, but listening for me, it's afterwards, voilà, really taking it into account, what, well, integrating it, what, and that's something else, what. Okay, yeah, three.

I: Hop, now, if I ask you how dissatisfied she is with your relationship, from completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied?

P: Well, I hesitate between rather dissatisfied and very dissatisfied, because, at the same time, it's also between, effectively, we stop everything, because at some point, I'm not happy and I see that you're not either, even if you're burying your head in the sand, but at the same time, I'm not unhappy, well, there you go, so it's a bit... In between, yeah. Yeah, it's a bit ambivalent. I'd say I'm still pretty dissatisfied.

I: Ok. So, if I ask you how satisfied you are with this relationship, between at least 10 and 10, how much would you say?

P: I'd say... I don't know, I'd have to go a little negative. That's what's... I really talked about separation and it's not something I've ruled out yet, but at the same time, in my mind, completely dissatisfied, it's really, well, I won't be there yet and almost, well, there would be disrespect, mistreatment, etc., what. So I know I'm not satisfied. In the meantime, I'm still here and it's not an emergency to end my relationship. So I want to be... I'm going to stay on zero, in fact. I'm going to stay on zero because, at least, I think it's really when you're... I mean, that would really be very unhappy and very uncomfortable, so zero. And finally, it's a bit hard to put zero, but in fact, it's really about appearing in the middle. Because I really have the impression that there are things that are still good, things that bother me, but let's just say it's staying a bit in the middle.

I: Ok, yes. Thanks a lot. Ah, well then, I'll stop the presentation. I'll also stop recording.